

Ashutosh Sharma

— Punjab Kings

Ashutosh Sharma has often rescued Punjab Kings (PBKS) from tough spots with his strong performances in the lower-middle order this season.

He broke into the scene against Gujarat Titans at the Narendra Modi Stadium. Ashutosh got together with Shashank Singh for the seventh wicket, with Kings needing 50 runs off 27 deliveries. The 25-year-old scored 31 off 16 deliveries in a 43-run stand to pull off an unlikely three-wicket win for Punjab.

He was in a similar situation against Mumbai Indians, walking in with his side reeling at 77 for six in a 192-run chase. Ashutosh scored 61 runs off just 28 deliveries to prolong Punjab's fight.

Among batters who have played at least 50 balls at number seven or lower this IPL, Ashutosh's strike rate of 189.28 is second only to Andre Russell.

Innings: 5 | Runs: 159 | Average: 39.75 |
Strike Rate: 189.28 | HS: 61 | 50s: 1



Tilak Varma

— Mumbai Indians

Tilak Varma has been the silver lining in an otherwise dismal campaign for Mumbai Indians (MI).

The southpaw has held the MI batting unit in place when its big guns Rohit Sharma, Ishan Kishan, and Suryakumar Yadav have been inconsistent. He started the season with a 34-ball 64 that allowed his side to at least make a run at the record run chase of 277 against Sunrisers Hyderabad.

Tilak brought up two more fifties later in the competition to become the third-youngest player behind Rishabh Pant and Yashasvi Jaiswal to cross 1000 runs in the IPL.

With three games still in hand, Tilak is on course to better his 395-run debut season in 2022, which remains his best return with the bat in the competition.

Innings: 11 | Runs: 347 | Average: 38.55 |
Strike Rate: 151.52 | HS: 65 | 50s: 3

